

How the system works

The counter, the customers, the suppliers, the stock, the money and the people — the whole shop, and how to run it from one screen.

Everything in one place.

Written for the people who use it every day.

Keep a copy by the till.

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HOW TO READ THIS

You do not have to read it end to end. Part 1 is worth ten minutes for anybody new. After that, go to the part that matches what you are doing. Every part stands on its own.

Boxes down the side mean something. **Watch out** is a mistake that costs money. **Worth knowing** saves you time. **Why it works this way** explains a decision, so it stops feeling arbitrary.

1

Getting started

What the system is, how to get into it, and how to make the screen yours.

1.1 What this system is

It is the whole shop on one screen. The till that makes the bill is the same system that knows what stock is left, what the customer owes, what you owe the supplier, what the staff worked this month and what the shop made today. Nothing is typed twice.

Because it is one system, a bill made at the counter changes seven things at once: the stock comes down, the customer's balance goes up if it was on credit, the day's takings go up, the profit is worked out from what that item cost, the accounts are posted, the cheque is recorded if one was given, and the customer gets a text if you have that switched on.

1.2 The addresses

The same system answers on several addresses, and each one is for different people. Give out the right one.

Address	Who it is for
<code>/pos</code>	You and your staff. The till and everything behind it. This is the main system, behind the lock screen.
<code>/</code>	Customers, in public. The shop's own website — what you sell, at the prices you set for online.
<code>/supplier</code>	Your suppliers. They sign in and see your orders, confirm them, mark goods dispatched, and ask to be paid.
<code>/my/...</code>	One customer. Their own page — what they owe, their bills, and a way to tell you they have paid.
<code>/shift</code>	Staff clocking in. The shift clock.
<code>/b/...</code>	Anybody with the link. One bill, to look at on a phone. This is what goes in the text message.

1.3 Signing in

Open `/pos` and you get the lock screen with the staff list on it. Pick your name, put in your password, and you are in. The system remembers who you are on that machine, so you are not picking your name off the list twenty times a day.

WATCH OUT

Your sign-in is **you**, not the machine. Every bill, every price change, every discount carries the name of whoever was signed in. If you walk away and somebody else uses the till under your name, it is your name on it. Sign out when you leave the counter for good.

1.4 Making the screen yours

Under **Settings** → **My screen**, four things are yours alone. They travel with your sign-in, so your screen is your screen on whichever machine you sit at.

Setting	What it does
The menu	Down the side, or across the top. Across the top gives the width to the work, which suits the till.
Narrow menu	Icons only, with names appearing when you hover. More room for the work.
Where you land	The page you get after signing in. A cashier probably wants the till; you probably want the dashboard.
Which till	Three styles — see 2.2. Pick the one that suits how you work, not how somebody else works.

1.5 Who can see what

Not everybody sees the whole menu. What a person sees is decided by their **role**.

Role	Sees
Super Admin Owner Admin	Everything, including costs, margins, the trail and AI support.
KP	The counter, suppliers, stock, online, money and people — but not users, and not the trail.
Salesman	The dashboard, products and their own attendance. Nothing else.
Your own roles	You can make roles of your own and tick exactly which sections they get. See 8.3.

WHY IT WORKS THIS WAY

Cost and margin are the two figures that should not be on a screen a customer can lean over and read. That is why the trail and AI support are kept to the owner and admins, and why the cost code (5.3) exists at all.

1.6 How your work is saved

Everything the shop knows is kept together and shared between every till. When you finish a bill on one machine, the other machines have it seconds later. You do not save anything by hand.

IF TWO PEOPLE CHANGE THE SAME THING

The system notices and keeps both people honest rather than letting one quietly overwrite the other. If you are told your copy is out of date, let it pick up the newer one and do your change again — it takes a moment and it means nothing is lost.

2

At the counter

The work that pays for everything else: making the bill, and taking the money.

2.1 The dashboard

The first thing most people see. It is laid out in headed sections so you can go straight to the part you care about instead of hunting through a wall of numbers:

Sales & profit

What went out today, what it made, how the week is going.

Customers

Who owes what, who has gone past their limit, what came in.

Suppliers

What you owe, what is falling due, what is on order.

Money & costs

Cash, bank, cheques in hand, cheques out, expenses.

It keeps itself up to date quietly in the background. You do not need to refresh it.

2.2 The till — three styles

The same bill, three ways of keying it. Choose under **Settings** → **My screen** → **Which till**.

Style	Suits
Classic till	Keyboard first. Scan, quantity, price, Enter . The payment window has a key for each way of paying. Fastest once you know it, and the least mouse.
The screen you know	The familiar counter layout, with the customer band along the top and the held bills and clear buttons up there with it.
Quick	Fewer things on screen, bigger targets. Good on a touch screen.

2.3 Making a bill

1. **Put the item on.** Scan the barcode, or type part of the name and pick it. The price comes from the product — the retail price, or the wholesale price if the customer is set to that level, or a tier price if the quantity earns one.
2. **Change the quantity** if it is not one.
3. **Change the price or give a discount** if you are allowed to. See the warning below.
4. **Repeat** until the bill is complete.
5. **Take the payment** — see 2.5.

WATCH OUT — SELLING UNDER COST

If a line ends up below what the item cost the shop, the system stops the bill and an admin has to allow it. That is not the system being difficult: it is the one mistake that turns a busy day into a losing day, and it is almost always a typing slip in the price.

2.4 The customer on the bill

A cash sale to somebody passing does not need a name. Anything on credit does — the system will not let a credit sale go through without one, because there would be nobody to collect from.

On **the screen you know**, the customer button sits in the customer band along the top. On the classic till,

F4 opens the customer picker.

2.5 Taking payment

Six ways, and you can mix them on one bill — part cash, part cheque, the rest on credit.

Way	What happens
Cash	Into the drawer, and into the day's cash figure.
Card	Into the bank account you pick.
Bank	A transfer, into the account you pick.
Cheque	Recorded as a cheque in hand, with its number, bank and date, so it turns up in Cheques in until you bank it.
Points	Against what the customer has earned. Needs a named customer.
Voucher	Against a voucher's remaining balance, which is checked before anything is posted.

Whatever is left unpaid becomes credit, and the bill becomes a credit sale.

2.6 Credit, and limits

Every customer can have a credit limit. If a bill would take them past it, the system stops and a manager has to allow it. If they have paid money in advance, that advance is used up first before anything goes on credit.

WORTH KNOWING

A limit is not a wall, it is a question. The point is that somebody senior sees it happen rather than finding out a month later. When you do allow it, that decision is recorded.

2.7 Holding a bill

A customer goes to fetch something, or wants to pay later in the day. Hold the bill and serve the next person. The **Held** button at the top carries a count of how many are waiting; press it and you see every held bill and

what is inside each one, so you can pick the right one back up.

F7 holds the bill. **F5** shows what is being held.

2.8 Quotations and delivery notes

A bill that is not a sale yet. Put the items on as normal and save it as a quotation instead of taking payment. You will be asked whether to save it as a quotation or to put a reference on it — a job name, a site, the customer's own order number. Leaving the reference blank is fine.

Quotations and delivery notes live under **Quotes & delivery notes**, and a quotation can be turned into a real bill when the customer says yes, without keying it again.

2.9 Returns

Put the item on the bill with a **negative quantity**. It goes back into stock at what it was sold for, so the profit figures stay true rather than being flattered by a return at today's price.

2.10 The questions at the end of a bill

When a bill finishes, the system can ask two things. Both are switched on or off under **Settings → Finishing a bill**.

Question	What it is for
The mobile number	Type the customer's number and the bill goes to their name. Leave it blank and it stays a counter sale. This is the easiest way to build the customer list without slowing the queue.
Who sold it	Puts the salesperson on the bill, so Sales by Cashier and any commission actually mean something.

2.11 Bills

Bills (**F9**) is every bill you have made — search it, reprint, look at what was on it, send the link again. The link in the text message opens one bill on a phone, and nothing else.

3

Customers

Who owes you, how to collect it, and how to let them see it themselves.

3.1 The customer list

Search, sort and filter down the left; everything about the customer they are on down the right — their balance, their bills, their payments, their statement. Their credit limit is there but kept quiet rather than shouted, because what matters day to day is what they owe.

3.2 Taking a payment

Take a payment () is for money coming in against what is already owed — not a sale. Pick the customer, put in what they gave you and how, and it comes off their balance. A cheque taken here lands in **Cheques in** exactly as one taken at the till does.

3.3 Notes and reminders

Some things are not transactions but you still need to remember them — an overpayment to sort out, a dispute, a promise made. Put a note on the customer, with a number on it if there is a figure involved.

WHY IT WORKS THIS WAY

A note with a number on it is deliberately **not** posted to the ledger. It is a flag, not an entry. If it posted, every half-remembered promise would quietly change what the books say the customer owes. Settle it properly when you know the answer, and clear the note.

3.4 Statements

A statement is the customer's own account, over a stretch of time — what they bought, what they paid, what is left. This is what you send when somebody says they have already paid.

3.5 The customer's own page

Each customer can have their own page at , where they see what they owe, their bills, and can tell you they have paid. It saves a great many phone calls.

You do not manage a list of who signs in. The system makes a user name from the customer's name and a password, and you text it to them. If they need somebody else from their side to have access — their accountant, their storekeeper — **they ask from their own page**, the request comes to you, and the new sign-in is only made once you accept it.

4

Suppliers

What you owe, when it is due, and how to buy without running yourself short.

4.1 Suppliers and orders

The supplier list works like the customer list. **Supplier orders** is what you have asked for and not yet received. A supplier with a sign-in can see their orders on their own page, confirm them, ask for a change, or mark them dispatched with the invoice number.

4.2 Purchases — booking goods in

Goods arrive; you book them in against the supplier's invoice. Stock goes up, what you owe goes up, and the cost on each line becomes the cost the system uses for profit from then on. Transport and other charges are spread across the lines by value, so the cost of the goods is the real cost of getting them onto the floor.

A purchase can also be booked by its invoice total with the invoice photographed, when there is no time to key every line.

4.3 Payment requests

Instead of a supplier ringing to ask when they will be paid, they ask through the system, and the request moves through the shop in the open.

1. **The supplier checks what is outstanding** on their own page.
2. **They pick the bills** they want paying, and note anything that has changed — an invoice value that is wrong, a credit note, a short delivery.
3. **They send the request.**
4. **You, the admins and accounts all see it**, with a count on the menu so it is not missed.
5. **Somebody checks it and accepts it.**
6. **The payment is made ready**, and the supplier is told it is ready.
7. **Accounts issues the cheque or the cash** and marks it issued.

Every step is recorded with who did it, so "nobody told me" stops being a possible answer.

4.4 Purchasing & cash plan

This is the part that keeps the shop out of trouble. It puts what you are going to owe next to what is going to come in, and tells you the first day you run short. Four tabs:

Tab	What it shows
The plan	Week by week: what is coming in, what is going out, and what is left. If there is a day you run short, it names the day, says what lands on it, and says how far under you go.

What falls due	Every bill part and every cheque you have written, nearest first. Anything here can be cut into cheques under your ceiling.
Credit periods	How long each supplier gives you — and where a supplier gives different terms for different kinds of goods, that is set per category, not per supplier.
Season & rules	Your cheque ceiling, how far back to look when judging normal takings, how much cash to keep back, and the season dial for the months when trade drops.

WORTH KNOWING

The cheque ceiling is the figure you almost never go above — a hundred thousand, in your case. When something falls due that is bigger, the system will cut it into several cheques under the ceiling and space them out, rather than leaving you to work it out on paper.

WATCH OUT

The plan is only as honest as the credit periods you have put in. A supplier whose terms are blank is assumed to want paying sooner than they really do, and that makes the plan look tighter than it is. Filling in **Credit periods** properly is an hour that pays for itself.

5

Stock

What you have, what it cost, what it sells for, and what is not moving.

5.1 A product

Field	What it means
Name	What you and your staff call it. This is what gets searched, so name it the way somebody would ask for it.
Barcode	Scanned at the till.
Category	Groups it for reports, for online, and for supplier credit periods.
Unit	Bag, length, piece, tin.
Cost	What it cost you. Everything about profit rests on this being right. See 5.2.
Retail	The counter price.
Wholesale	For customers set to that level.
MRP	The printed price, where there is one.
Online price	A different price on the website. See 6.2.
Minimum	The level at which you want telling. Below it, the item shows up as running low and in the reorder report.

5.2 Prices, and which one is used

An item does not have one price, it has a ladder. Knowing which rung gets used, and when, is the difference between a healthy margin and a puzzling one.

Price	When it is used
Cost	Never charged. It is what the goods cost you, and it is what every profit figure in the system is measured against. It is set when you book the goods in, with transport spread across the lines.
Retail	The normal counter price. What most bills use.
Wholesale	Used automatically when the customer on the bill is set to the wholesale level. You do not have to remember who gets trade prices — the customer record does.
Tier price	A price that depends on how many they take. Ten bags at one price, a hundred at another. Applied by quantity, without anybody having to work it out.
Online price	Only on the website. See 6.2.

WHY IT WORKS THIS WAY

The cost is stored **on the bill line**, not just on the product. That means the profit on a bill from three months ago is worked out from what the goods cost **then**, not what they cost today. If it used today's cost, every price rise from a supplier would quietly rewrite your history and make old months look worse than they were.

WORTH KNOWING

If a customer should always get trade prices, set their **level** on their record once, rather than typing the wholesale price by hand every time. Typed prices are where margin leaks — and a typed price is the thing that trips the under-cost stop at the worst moment.

5.3 The cost code

A way of writing the cost on the label so your staff can read it and the customer cannot. Set it under **Settings** → **Cost code**.

5.4 Inventory and the ledger

Every movement of every item is kept — sold, bought, returned, damaged, adjusted, transferred — with what it was, when, on which document, and what the stock stood at afterwards. When a figure looks wrong, this is where you find out what happened rather than guessing.

5.5 Stock take

Count what is actually on the floor, put the counts in, and the system shows you the difference and posts the adjustment. Do it in sections rather than trying to do the whole shop in one go.

5.6 Barcode labels

Pick items, pick a label size, print the sheet. On this page jumps to the search, pick the label type, and prints the sheet.

5.7 Damage returns and repair jobs

Damage returns takes broken or unsellable stock off the floor and records why, so it shows as a loss rather than silently vanishing. **Repair job notes** keeps track of things taken in for repair, so nothing sits in the back for three months with nobody knowing whose it is.

6

Online

The website, the prices on it, the orders off it, and telling people about it.

6.1 The shop site

The public website at is fed by the same products as the till. Under **The shop site** you set what it looks like and what it shows. Under **Online products** you choose which items appear, write their descriptions and set which are featured.

6.2 A different price online

What you charge over the counter and what you charge online do not have to be the same. Set an **online price** on a product and the website uses that; leave it empty and the website uses the normal price. You can set them one at a time or in bulk, and the difference from the counter price is shown as you go so you can see what you are doing.

WATCH OUT

An online price that is below cost is still below cost. The website will sell at whatever you put there — it does not stop you the way the till does.

6.3 Online orders

Orders from the website come into **Online orders** to be looked at and turned into real bills. They do not touch stock until you accept them.

6.4 Social

Write once, and post to Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp. You can send it now or set it for later. The page walks you through connecting each one the first time.

ON WHATSAPP

WhatsApp is not a noticeboard — it goes to people one at a time, and there is a sensible ceiling on how many in one go. Use it for things that are genuinely worth a customer's attention, or people stop reading anything you send.

7

Money

Cheques both ways, what the shop spends, and the books underneath.

7.1 Cheques in

Every cheque taken from a customer, with its number, its bank, its date and who it came from. It sits here as a cheque in hand until you bank it, and then it moves on. This page answers "how much have we got in cheques that is not in the bank yet", which is a different question from how much cash you have.

7.2 Cheques out

Every cheque the shop has written, and when it falls due. These feed straight into the purchasing plan (4.4), because a cheque you have written is money that is going to leave.

7.3 Expenses

Everything the shop spends that is not stock — transport, electricity, wages, rent, repairs. Each one has a category, and the categories are what make **Expenses by Category** worth reading.

WORTH KNOWING

Gross profit is what you made on the goods. It is not what the shop made. The gap between the two is this page. If expenses are not being entered properly, the shop looks more profitable than it is — which is the most expensive kind of wrong.

7.4 Accounting

The double entry behind everything else. You do not have to work here day to day — every bill, payment, purchase and expense posts itself. It is here for when your accountant asks, and for the reports in 9.3 that come straight off it.

The accounts you will meet most often:

Account	What it holds
1010	Cash in hand
1030	Cheques received, not yet banked
1100	What customers owe you
2050	Money a customer paid in advance, held until a bill uses it
2100	What you owe suppliers
2110	Cheques you have written that have not cleared

8

People

Who may do what, who was here, and what they are owed.

8.1 Approvals

Some things should not happen just because somebody clicked. Those things raise an approval, which the owner or an approver sees and decides on. Approvals are **on by default**.

What needs one	Why
Changing a price	A price is the shop's margin. A slip here is money, every time it sells.
Adjusting a bill	Changing a bill after the fact is the classic way money goes missing.
Adjusting a purchase	Same reason, from the other side.
Editing or removing a customer	Their balance and history hang off that record.
Changing a customer's terms	Credit terms are a commercial decision, not a counter one.
Giving portal access	To a customer or a supplier — it lets somebody outside the shop see your figures.

Each of these can be switched off under **Settings** → **Approvals**, but think hard before you do.

8.2 Attendance and pay

The whole thing in seven tabs:

Tab	What it is
Today	Who is in, who is not, who came late.
Attendance	The month as a sheet. Present, absent, holiday, leave — marked per person per day.
Payroll	What each person has earned for the month, worked out from the sheet and the rules.
Payments	What has actually been paid out, and what is still owed.
Trends	Lateness and absence over time, per person.
Staff	The people, their rates and their details.
Rules	Hours, overtime, what counts as late, and how pay is worked out.

Staff clock in at , and the fingerprint machine feeds the same record.

8.3 Users, roles and permissions

Add people, set their password, give them a role. You can build roles of your own and tick exactly which sections they get, which is better than giving somebody Admin because it was quicker.

WATCH OUT

Giving somebody Admin gives them costs, margins, the trail and AI support. If what they really need is to take payments and look at stock, make a role that does that.

9

Looking back

What happened, who did it, and what the figures say.

9.1 The trail

Owner and admins only. Every change of consequence, with who made it and when. This is what you read when a figure is not what you expected, and it is why arguments about what happened are short.

9.2 Messages

Every text and WhatsApp message the system has sent, and whether it went. Useful when a customer says they were never told.

9.3 Reports

Thirty-three reports in eight groups. Pick one, pick the dates, read it.

Business overview

Profit and Loss	What the shop made over a stretch, after expenses.
Balance Sheet	What the shop owns and owes, at a date.
Statement of Cash Flows	Where the money actually came from and went.
Day Book	One day, everything that happened in it.
Sales by Day	Day by day, for spotting the pattern.

Who owes you

A/R Ageing Summary	How overdue the money is, in bands. Read this one weekly.
A/R Ageing Detail	The same, bill by bill.
Customer Balance Summary	What each customer owes.
Open Invoices	Every bill not yet settled.
Collections Report	What to chase, and who to chase it from.
Customer Balance Detail	One customer's account in full.

Sales and customers

Sales by Customer	Who your business actually comes from.
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Sales by Product	What sells.
Discounts and Returns	What is being given away, and by whom.
Sales by Cashier	Only as good as the salesperson question (2.10) being answered.

What you owe

A/P Ageing Summary	How overdue what you owe is.
Supplier Balance Summary	What you owe each supplier.
Unpaid Bills	Everything outstanding.
Purchases by Supplier	Where your buying goes.
Cheque Register	Every cheque, both ways.

Expenses and cash

Expenses by Category	Where the money goes that is not stock.
Cash and Bank Movement	In and out, account by account.
Cash in Hand — day by day	For checking the drawer against the books.

Products and stock

Inventory Valuation	What the stock on the floor is worth at cost.
Stock Movement Detail	Every movement of an item.
Below Reorder Level	What to buy. Read this one weekly.
Profit by Product	What actually earns, as against what merely sells.

Payroll

Payroll Summary	What was paid, and to whom.
Attendance Summary	Days worked, per person.

For my accountant

Trial Balance	Every account, debits against credits.
General Ledger	Every account, entry by entry.
Journal	Every posting the system made.
Transaction List by Date	Everything, in order.

Audit Log

What was changed after the fact.

10.1 What it is

A page where you ask about the shop in plain words and get an answer worked out from your own books. Not a search box, and not general advice off the internet — it is shown a summary of your actual sales, balances, stock, cheques and expenses, and told to answer only from those.

10.2 The four tabs

Tab	What it is for
Ask	Any question. "How much does Sunil owe me?" · "Which suppliers do I owe most, and when is it due?" · "What am I holding that is not selling?" · "Is anything being sold below cost?"
Today	One button. A short review of where the shop stands, covering only what needs attention.
Ideas	Ideas for growing the shop, each one tied to a figure in your books.
Writing	A product description for the website, or a post for Facebook, Instagram or WhatsApp.

10.3 Connecting it

Until a key is set, the page shows the setup guide instead. In short: make an account at **console.anthropic.com**, add some credit and **set a monthly spend limit**, create an API key, and put it in the server's environment settings as `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`. For the live site that is Vercel → Settings → Environment Variables, followed by a redeploy.

WATCH OUT

The key goes on the **server**, never into the app. Anything in the app is downloaded by every browser that opens the shop website, and a key taken from there could be used to spend your money. The spend limit on the account is the only hard stop on what this costs.

10.4 What to trust

The figures it is given are worked out the same way the till works them out — what a customer owes and what you owe a supplier come off the ledger, and profit is the bill total less what the goods cost. It is told to quote the figure it is reasoning from, so you can check it.

WORTH KNOWING

It can read, and it can advise. It **cannot change anything** — it does not make bills, move stock or touch a balance. The worst it can do is be wrong, which is why it shows its figures. Check anything before you act on it, the same as you would check a person.

11

Settings

Every tab, and what it changes. There is a search box at the top — use it.

Tab	What it changes
My screen	Yours alone: the menu, how narrow it is, where you land, and which till. See 1.4.
Finishing a bill	Whether to ask for the customer's mobile, and whether to ask who sold it. See 2.10.
Privacy screen	Owner and admins. Blurs the figures on screen when somebody is leaning over the counter.
Shop details	Name, Sinhala name, address, landmark, phone, opening hours — what prints on the bill.
Bills & vouchers	Numbering and how documents behave.
What the bill shows	What is printed and what is left off.
Cost code	The letters that stand for digits on the price label. See 5.3.
Messaging	Texts and WhatsApp — whether they are live, and how they are sent.
Message templates	The wording of each message the system sends.
Attendance	Hours, the shift clock and the staff list behind it.
Approvals	Which actions need approving. See 8.1.



Keyboard shortcuts

Tear this page out and stick it by the till.

Anywhere in the system

Key	Goes to
F2	Dashboard
F3	The till
F7	Take a payment
F9	Bills

On the till

Key	Does
F1	Back to the item box, ready to scan or type
F3	Pick who sold it
F4	Pick the customer
F5	Show the held bills
F6	Credit sale
F7	Hold this bill
F8	Bill discount
F10	Take payment
F12	Show the last bill again
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + Q	Save as a quotation
Ctrl + H	Hold
Ctrl + R	Recall a held bill

On the classic till, **F2** with an item selected shows what that item has sold for before — useful when a customer says they paid less last time.

On the labels page

F1	Search		
F4	F5	F6	Label size
F10	Print the sheet		

The addresses

B

Who to give which one to.

Give this out to	Address
Nobody outside the shop	<code>/pos</code> — the till and the whole system
Everybody	<code>/</code> — the shop's website
A supplier	<code>/supplier</code> — with their own sign-in
A customer	<code>/my/...</code> — with their own sign-in
Your staff	<code>/shift</code> — clocking in
Anyone, for one bill	<code>/b/...</code> — the link in the text message

A routine



The system will tell you plenty. These are the things worth looking at on purpose.

Every day

- The dashboard, once, before you open.
- Cash in the drawer against **Cash in Hand — day by day**, at close.
- Any approval waiting on you. They sit there until somebody decides.
- Any payment request from a supplier.

Every week

- **A/R Ageing Summary** — who is slipping, before it becomes a year old.
- **Below Reorder Level** — what to buy.
- **The plan** in Purchasing & cash plan — is there a day coming where you run short?
- Cheques in hand that have not been banked.

Every month

- **Profit and Loss** — what the shop actually made, not what it sold.
- **Expenses by Category** — what crept up.
- **Profit by Product** — what earns as against what merely moves.
- Payroll, and the attendance sheet behind it.
- A stock take on one section, rotating through the shop.

WORTH KNOWING

If you only ever do one of these, make it the weekly **A/R Ageing Summary**. Money owed to a hardware shop does not usually vanish in one go — it ages quietly until it is too old to ask for.

When something goes wrong

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The handful of things that actually happen.

What you see	What to do
"Not enough stock" when there plainly is	The floor and the books disagree. Sell it, then put it right with a stock take on that item rather than fighting the message — and look at the movement ledger (5.4) to see where they parted company.
A price change will not go through	It needs approving (8.1). An owner or admin has to allow it.
"Under cost — an admin has to allow it"	Check the price you typed first. Nine times in ten it is a slip, not a decision.
A credit sale is refused	Either there is no customer on the bill, or they are at their limit. Both are deliberate.
Your copy is out of date	Somebody else changed the same thing first. Let it pick up the newer one and do your change again.
A customer says they never got the text	Messages (9.2) shows every message and whether it went.
A figure is not what you expected	The trail (9.1) for who changed what. The Audit Log report for what was changed after the fact. The movement ledger for stock.
The whole system will not load	Check the internet first — it is nearly always that. The shop's own machines cannot reach the books without it.

ONE LAST THING

Almost everything in this system is recoverable, because almost nothing is truly deleted — it is recorded as having happened, and then recorded as having been put right. That is why the trail exists, and it is why you should never be afraid to fix a mistake properly rather than hiding it.